

ZETDC EASTERN REGION		
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Personal Protective Equipment Procedure is to ensure that all personnel are adequately protected from anticipated and recognized workplace hazards through the identification, issuance, maintenance and use of Personal Protective Equipment/ Clothing (PPE/Cs).

2. Scope

This Procedure covers all ZETDC Eastern Region operations and it addresses eye, face, head, foot, and hand and torso (body) protection.

3. Responsibilities

3.1 Management

- Use engineering and administrative controls to limit employee exposure.
- Provide adequate PPE for all employees.
- Post appropriate signs and warnings in areas where mandatory PPE are to be worn.
- Conduct PPE reviews annually or when changes occur that affect the need for, or effectiveness of, PPE and must be updated as needed.
- Conduct training on use of PPE for all new employees, prior to initial use.
- Conduct annual refresher training for all employees.

3.2 Employees

- Use or wear company-issued / approved PPE/C in designated areas and / or hazard communicated.
- Request new PPE when needed.
- Exercise proper care of issued PPE/C.

4. Definitions

4.1 Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): all equipment that provides a barrier against the harmful elements including clothing, which intended to be worn or held by a person at work and in the process, protects him against one or more risks to his / her health or safety.

4.2 Physical harmful elements: - electricity, noise, vibration, radiation etc

4.3 Chemical harmful elements: dusts, vapours, mists, fumes, acids

4.4 Biological agents: fungi, bacteria, viruses.

5. Program Description

PROGRAMME ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
5.1 Compliance 5.1.1 Maintain and keep current copies of applicable local regulations and other applicable requirements and implement the stricter of these regulations concerning PPE.	HRAM/ District Manager
5.2 Hazard Identification & Risk Assessments 5.2.1 Conduct risk assessments to establish the different hazards in the work place and subsequently identify which types of PPE are suitable to protect against the hazard and for the job to be done. The PPE risk assessments shall be review annually, updated immediately on commencement of changes in production, processes, equipment or controls that affect the need for, or effectiveness of PPE.	HRAM/ District Manager
5.3. Mandatory PPE Use Communication In all areas where use of PPE is mandatory, conspicuous signage is displayed showing the type of personal protective equipment required in that section. It is the duty of management to provide this personal protective equipment to workers and enforce the use thereof.	HRAM / District Manger
5.4 PPE Selection The selection of PPE that is appropriate for the task should be done by one who is familiar with the potential work hazards and the type of protective equipment that is available. Advice / Information must be obtained from the supplier/ manufacturer on the different types of PPE available and how suitable they are for different tasks. PPE will be selected to address the specific hazards identified, based on type, materials and intended use: 1. Eye and face Protection - Safety glasses, goggles or face shields will be provided as appropriate to the identified hazard: side shields (incorporated into the design) are required where there is a hazard from flying objects. Designated employees who wear prescription lenses will be provided with eye protection that will fit over the lenses without disturbing their proper position. 2. Respiratory Protection – respirators or dust masks shall be provided where there is considerable amount of dust, vapour and fumes. 3. Head Protection – Hard hats will be provided where there is a hazard from falling objects, overhead obstructions, or overhead electrical conductors. 4. Foot Protection – Employees must wear protective (steel toe / shank) shoes where there is a danger of falling or rolling objects, piercing the sole, or exposure to electrical hazards. 5. Electrical Protective Equipment – EPE, matting, covers, rubber switching gloves or other insulating materials, shall be properly marked with the insulation level, proofed, inspected and provided for use.	EM/ HRAM

6. **Hand Protection** – Gloves of appropriate type, size and materials shall be provided where there is a hazard from skin absorption of hazardous energy or substances, severe cuts, lacerations, abrasions or punctures, chemical.
7. **Hearing Protection** – Earplugs or earmuffs shall be provided where there is noise hazard.
8. **Protective Clothing** - Protective clothing for arms or body must be worn as indicated in the workplace risk assessment for protection against chemical, abrasion, cut and electrical hazards.

All PPE must be based on the assessed hazard, and must not impair the employee's ability to see, hear, communicate or perform their task safely. The HRAM will co-ordinate the purchase of all PPE, though the Procurement Officer, to maintain the uniformity of training and use.

5.5 Employee Training

The HRAM will coordinate and / or provide annual training for employees who are required to use PPE. Records of training will be kept by the respective Centre, Risk Management and Human Resources for 3 Years. Training is mandatory for any employee prior to using any PPE, and shall include (at a minimum) the following components

- The nature of identified hazards, and consequences of improper PPE use
- Available engineering and administrative controls and the need for PPE
- Reasons for selection of a particular type of PPE
- Methods of inspection, check fit and operation of PPE
- Proper maintenance, cleaning and storage of the PPE
- General Requirements of the Factories and Works Act
 - Chapter (14:08) and Statutory Instrument 68 of 1990
 - RGN 302 of 1976 (Machinery Regulations)
 - Section 24 Grinding
 - Section 36 Welding
 - RGN 263 of 1976 (General Regulations)
 - Section 6- Hearing Protection
 - Section 8 – All Protective clothing
 - Section 12 – Respiratory Protection
 - RGN 264 of 1976 (Building and Excavation Work Regulations)
 - Section 14- Hard Hats
 - Section 17 – Safety Belts
 - RGN 304 of 1976 (Electrical Regulations)
 - Section 9
 - Electricity Act (Chapter 13:19) 2002
 - Electrical Safety Rules Second Edition, 1998

Retraining of employees is required whenever

- Changes in the workplace render the previous training obsolete
- Changes in the type of PPE render the previous training obsolete
- Management observes inadequacies in an employees' knowledge or use of assigned PPE that indicates an employee has not retained the necessary understanding or skill.

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Note – All temporary or contract workers are required to comply with any PPE requirements established by their Management for that specific work place, and will receive instruction in its use as part of their new employee orientation.	
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6. RECORDS

The following records shall be generated from implementation of this procedure.

Name of record:	Custodian/ location:	Retention period:
PPE & uniforms profiles	HRAM/ Depot Foreperson	3 years
Training records	HRAM	3 years
PPE compliance assessments	HRAM	3 years

7. REFERENCES

7.1 RGN 263 /1976 Factories and Works (General) Regulations,1976